

BRAND STYLE GUIDE

Brand Tokens & UI System

Live source of truth for the Uni Textbook Marketplace project. The styling classes and color tokens mapped out below directly correspond to our global CSS configuration.

EVOLUTION FROM DEMO 1

Our Brand style guide started out as basic values pulled directly from marketing concepts. While those choices worked well for structural layouts in Demo 1, building live functional views quickly exposed accessibility issues.

Specifically, our primary brand cyan (`#00B4D8`) caused severe text visibility issues on white panels. To address this for WCAG AA compliance, we split it to include a deeper secondary cyan (`#006D8A`) to safely handle text elements, navigation references, and links.

The landing page layout also went through multiple structural iterations. Initial ideas favored complex serif display patterns, highlighting overlays, and stacked sample cards. To keep production assets clean, the final shipped hero uses a full-bleed campus photo with clean Montserrat text layers, emphasizing our slogan: **"Made for Students, by Students"**. Deploying this documentation page directly within the app pipeline allows us to track visual consistency across components in real-time.

EVOLUTION FROM DEMO 2

Demo 2 marked a significant visual overhaul, moving away from flat, utilitarian designs toward a more polished, engaging UI. Our core focus was enhancing user experience through consistent visual hierarchy, improved interactivity, and cohesive branding across all authenticated pages.

Glossy & Glassmorphism Design Language: We introduced glossy hero sections with gradient backgrounds, subtle light reflections, and decorative patterns across all major pages including Browse, Wishlist, My Listings, Messages, and Notifications. Cards now feature hover shadows,

rounded corners, and glass-like transparency effects (`backdrop-filter: blur(10px)`) creating a premium, modern feel.

Badge System Expansion: The badge system was significantly extended from the original three queue statuses (Pending, Approved, Rejected) to include color-coded condition badges (New, Good, Fair, Poor) and sale status badges (Reserved, Sold). These now appear consistently across filter sidebars and listing cards, improving scannability and visual communication.

Component Refinements: The multi-step form steppers were redesigned from basic dots to flag/arrow shapes with clear progress indicators. Listing cards were enhanced with larger images, improved typography, and a glossy hover effect. The messaging interface received a complete refresh with avatars, grouped messages by date, and an improved input area with an icon-based send button.

Dark Mode Support: Full dark mode compatibility was implemented across all routes, with CSS variables managing theme transitions. Hero sections maintain their light gradient backgrounds regardless of theme to preserve visual consistency. Components now adapt seamlessly with `dark:` Tailwind variants.

Consistent Hero Sections: A unified hero section pattern was established across all pages using a dark-to-light cyan gradient with a student-focused image overlay (student reading a book). Each page features a relevant icon (heart for Wishlist, package for My Listings, etc.) and a glass-morphism container, creating a cohesive brand experience.

Button & Interaction Updates: Secondary/outline buttons now use white backgrounds with cyan borders and hover states. The view and dismiss action buttons in admin panels follow this pattern, while destructive actions (Delete, Reject, Ban) retain red styling. All interactive elements received `cursor-pointer` for better UX.

COLOUR PALETTE

Core tokens carried over from the initial design sprint, along with text compliance fixes. Contrast mappings are documented inside `globals.css`.

CORE BASE

Primary Cyan

#00B4D8

Main interactive elements, primary CTAs, and bold heading highlights.

Primary Cyan Hover

#0096B4

Hover state for primary cyan (10% darker variant).

Dark Navy

#000f2b

Main backgrounds & button text on light fills.

Dark Grey

#3a3a3a

Standard body text across all layouts.

Subtle Grey

#4B4F58

Meta labels, placeholder inputs, captions.

Light grey

#F5F5F5

Card backgrounds, internal panels, empty text wrappers.

Border Grey

#dddddd

Layout dividers.

REFINED VALIDATION BADGES (WCAG AA COMPLIANCE)

Link / Secondary Cyan

#005D8A

Inline links & secondary buttons (Refined for AA compliance)

Ratio: 5.1:1 on white

Danger Red

#dc2626

Delete or withdraw listing actions

Ratio: 4.6:1

Badge, Pending

#D0F0F7 / #004F66

Queue moderation badge state

Ratio: 7.1:1

Badge, Approved

#D0F0DC / #155E2E

Live listing badge state

Ratio: 7.4:1

Badge, Rejected

#FDE8E8 / #7F1D1D

Moderator rejection badge state

Ratio: 8.1:1

Badge, Reserved

#ddc4fe / #8327e5

Listing reserved badge state

Ratio: 7.1:1

Badge, Sold



#c6c6c6 / #606060

Listing sold badge state

Ratio: 8.1:1



#E3F2FD / #1565C0

Filter condition badge for "Like New" listings

Ratio: 7.1:1



#E8F5E9 / #2E7D32

Filter condition badge for "Good" condition listings

Ratio: 7.4:1



#FFF3E0 / #E65100

Filter condition badge for "Fair" condition listings

Ratio: 7.1:1



#FFEBEE / #C62828

Filter condition badge for "Poor" condition listings

Ratio: 8.1:1

Token Drift Warning: globals.css overrides

Headings currently resolve to #171717 via root configuration variables instead of using the designated brand Dark Navy colour. Additionally, layout grid dividers reference standard tailwind gray variants instead of our declared background borders. This mismatch will be updated in the next dev synchronisation pass.

TYPOGRAPHY SYSTEM

Our application interface relies entirely on the **Montserrat** font family for authenticated views, forms, and core navigation systems.

Element	Size	Weight	Line Height
H1	50px / 3.125rem	700	1.2
H2	28px / 1.75rem	700	1.3
H3	22px / 1.375rem	600	1.3
H4	18px / 1.125rem	600	1.3
Body	16px / 1rem	400	1.6

UI COMPONENT LIBRARY

Core components implemented in Demo 2 with their key styling attributes.

Listing Card

Product card with image, title, edition, price, condition badge, seller info, and wishlist heart.

Condition Badges

Color-coded badges for listing conditions (New, Good, Fair, Poor) used in filters and listing cards.

Status Badges

Queue status badges (Pending, Approved, Rejected) and sale status badges (Reserved, Sold).

Glossy Hero Sections

Full-width hero banners with gradient backgrounds, glossy overlays, and decorative patterns.

Glassmorphism Cards

Cards with backdrop blur, semi-transparent backgrounds, and subtle border effects.

Filter Sidebar

Collapsible filter panel with condition badge buttons, range inputs, and active filter count.

Multi-step Forms

Flag/arrow shaped steppers with progress indicators for listing creation and registration.

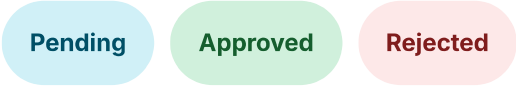
COMPONENT PREVIEW LIBRARY

Live element examples rendered with our global layout styling classes.

ACTION BUTTONS



QUEUE STATUS BADGES



CONDITION BADGES



SALE STATUS BADGES



ACCESSIBILITY FRAMEWORK

- Compliance Target: **WCAG 2.2 AA** interface baseline across all routes.
- Interactive elements utilize high-visibility focus rings (`rgba(0,180,216,.15)`).



- Condition and status badges maintain a minimum 4.5:1 contrast ratio on their respective backgrounds.

Default Motion On



Developed in collaboration with



Product

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